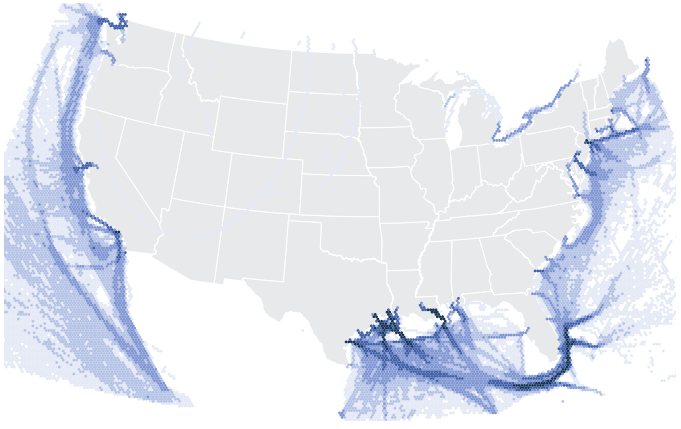
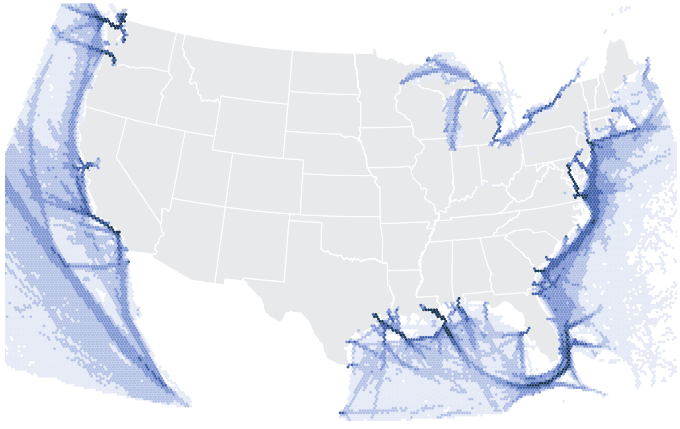
87% of tankers sail in Gulf waters, against 50% of cargo ships; passenger and government ships cluster at a few ports

Distinct ships of each type per 25 km hexagon, 2024 and 2025 together (each map has its own shading)

Tankers (4,438 ships)



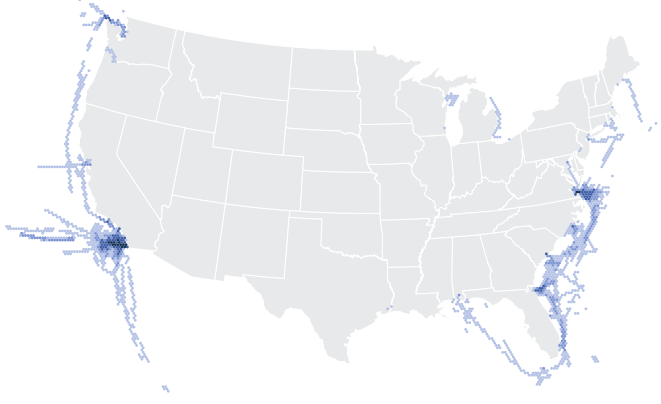
Cargo and container ships (10,485 ships)



Passenger ships (283 ships)



Military and law enforcement (88 ships)



Source: NTIA analysis of MarineCadastre AIS, 104 sampled days in 2024 and 2025; large ships = cargo, tanker, passenger, military, and other seagoing ships 100 m or longer, plus tug-barges near the coast. Types from the AIS ship-type code: tanker 80-89, cargo 70-79, passenger 60-69, military 35, law enforcement 55.